

Grace With Hard People

20–25 min · Week 26

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that grace toward hard people — the rude, prickly, or unkind — is a choice, with limits set by their own safety and dignity.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills · grace with discernment; Self-Management: limits
VOCABULARY	hard people · prickly · rude · limits · safety · dignity · cost
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · chart paper · scenario examples

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the small acts register. "Last lesson: small acts of grace. Today: what about with people who are HARD to be kind to?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"There is someone in my life who is prickly. They are not mean exactly — but they are HARD to be kind to. What do I do?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

Hard People Are Real

5 MIN

Validate: "Some people are hard. They are rude sometimes. They are prickly. They make us tense. They are real — in classrooms, in families, in life. We do not have to PRETEND they are easy.**"

2

Choose Your Grace

6 MIN

Build the framework: "With hard people, you CHOOSE your grace. Maybe small — a polite hello. Maybe medium — a kind word when they seem stressed. Maybe big — inviting them to sit with you. YOU decide. The amount can be small. The CHOICE is yours.**"

3

But Limits Are Real Too

6 MIN

State firmly: "AND — grace has LIMITS. If a hard person is hurting you — grace is NOT required. Your SAFETY matters. Your DIGNITY matters. You can give a tiny grace and STILL keep your distance. You can give NO grace if it costs you safety.**"